Document Control Report

Title Handling of Controlled Drugs in Operating Theatres and Anaesthetic Rooms Procedure			
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1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to ensure adherence to national guidelines of handling of controlled drugs in operating theatres and anaesthetic rooms which will ensure all patients, staff and visitors remain safe at all times in accordance with the Misuse of Drugs Act (1971).

The policy applies to all Trust that administer, supply or handle controlled drugs.

Implementation of this policy will ensure that:

- Risks associated with the use of controlled drugs are reduced
- Staff have clear guidelines to follow when handling controlled drugs

2 Definitions

2.1 Controlled Drug (CD)

A drug or medicine that is under the control of the Misuse of Drugs Act (1971)

2.2 Theatre Practitioner

A person who is qualified as an Operating Department Practitioner or a Registered General Nurse.

2.3 Anaesthetic Practitioner

A person who is qualified as an Operating Department Practitioner or a Registered General Nurse who has completed an anaesthetic practitioner module.

2.4 Accountable Officer

The person who has complete responsibility for the safe handling and management of Controlled drugs in an organisation. They must ensure there are systems in place for monitoring of controlled drugs in accordance with the Controlled Drugs (Supervision of Management and Use) Regulations, 2006.

2.5 Team Leader

The practitioner in charge of an operating theatre

3 Responsibilities

3.1 Role of Chief Executive

The Chief Executive has overall Responsibility for ensuring controlled drugs are used and handled safely in the operating theatres and that all staff involved in the prescription and administration of controlled drugs are competent to do so.

3.2 Role of all staff

It is the responsibility of all staff to ensure this policy is adhered to. Anyone handling a controlled drug or is involved in the storage or carriage of any controlled drug must be competent to do so as detailed in this policy.

3 Procedure for the Handling of Controlled Drugs in Operating Theatres and Anaesthetic Rooms

- This procedure applies to all staff working in operating theatres and anaesthetic rooms in the Northern Devon Healthcare NHS Trust.
- A theatre practitioner must be registered with the relevant governing body, such as the Nursing and Midwifery Council (NMC) or the Health and Care Professions Council (HCPC) in order to handle, possess and supply CDs.
- The team leader of each theatre will ensure that the policy is followed correctly by all theatre practitioners and the security of controlled drugs is maintained.

4.1 Storage of Controlled Drugs and Stationary

- CDs must be kept in a locked cupboard in accordance with the Misuse of Drugs Act (1971)
- CD stationary (CD order book and CD register) should be stored in a locked cupboard when not in use. Loss or theft of CD stationary must be reported to the chief pharmacist and Accountable Officer.
- Keys to the controlled drug cupboard must be carried by the anaesthetic practitioner allocated to that particular theatre and they are responsible for distributing CDs to the anaesthetist.
- The key-holder should be readily available at all times
- The cupboard must be kept locked when not in use
- The cupboard lock must not be similar to any other lock in the hospital
- The cupboard must be dedicated to CDs. Other items such as CD records which are kept in the locked cupboard must be stored in a separate space to the CDs.
- In the event of a stock check, the CD key can be given to an authorised pharmacy staff member
- If CD keys go missing, urgent efforts must be made to retrieve them. If they remain lost, the Theatre Manager and the Accountable Officer must be informed. A spare key must be available.
- If the keys are not found then the lock must be changed at the earliest opportunity.

4.2 Ordering of Controlled Drugs

Controlled drug orders must be written in the CD order book by an anaesthetic or theatre practitioner and taken to pharmacy.

The following details must be written in the CD order book for each order:

- Hospital

- Department/Area
- Name of drug/ size of ampoule
- Dosage: mg/ml
- Amount Required
- Signature and Printed Name
- Date

4.3 Receipt of Controlled Drugs

- When the CDs are delivered to theatre, the practitioner must sign the receipt as proof they have been received.
- The delivery person will take a copy of the receipt back to pharmacy for their records. A copy must be kept for theatre records also. They must be kept in the theatre and retained for 2 years. Requisition and order slips should be stored in a plastic sleeve/envelope in the CD cupboard.
- The CDs must be checked with another theatre staff member to ensure the order has been correctly received.
- The seal on the pouch must be intact. The CDs must be checked with the order book page number and the pharmacy slip to ensure they are correct.
- The CDs must be locked away in the cupboard.
- Any discrepancies must be raised with pharmacy immediately.
- The CD register must be updated and signed by both practitioners. The running balance must match with the CDs that are present.

4.4 Documentation of Distribution and Administration of Controlled Drugs

There is a Controlled Drug register in each anaesthetic room. This must be updated every time a CD is supplied with the following details:

- Date
- Name of patient and patient number
- Amount supplied and time of supply
- Amount administered and time of administration
- Amount discarded and time of discard
- Signature of anaesthetist
- Signature of Anaesthetic practitioner
- Stock amount of drug

Controlled drugs should not be transferred between operating theatres or departments.

If a documentation error is made, the error should be bracketed and not crossed out, signed and dated. This should be witnessed and signed by another healthcare professional.

Stock balances of controlled drugs should be checked after each theatre list by two theatre practitioners.

A stock list of the CDs used should be kept in each theatre which should reflect the types of surgery performed in order to prevent stocking drugs that are not used.

4.5 Discarding and Destroying Controlled Drugs

Individual doses of controlled drugs which are prepared but not used should be discarded. They should be emptied into a sharps bin along with the ampoule by the anaesthetist or the anaesthetic practitioner, then recorded and signed in the CD register. It is good practice to have a colleague witness the discarding of CDs.

All other controlled drugs, e.g. outdated stock, must be returned to the Pharmacy for destruction.

4.6 Archiving of Controlled Drug Records

Records must be stored for a minimum of 2 years from the last date of entry. Tracking and monitoring slips should also be kept for 2 years

6 Process for Implementation and Monitoring Compliance and Effectiveness

The policy will be highlighted to all Theatre staff.

Monitoring compliance with this procedure will be the responsibility of the Team Leaders of the Recovery department, each Operating Theatre and the Anaesthetic Support Manager. This will be undertaken by pharmacy stock checks which will provide feedback on areas to improve on.

Where non-compliance is identified, support and advice will be provided to improve practice.

7 Equality Impact Assessment

Group	Positive Impact	Negative Impact	No Impact	Comment
Age			X	
Disability			X	
Gender			X	
Gender Reassignment			X	
Human Rights (rights to privacy, dignity, liberty and non-degrading treatment), marriage and civil partnership			X	
Pregnancy			X	
Maternity and Breastfeeding			X	
Race (ethnic origin)			X	
Religion (or belief)			X	
Sexual Orientation				

8 References

- Misuse of Drugs Act (1971)
- Misuse of Drugs (Safe Custody) (Amendment) Regulations (2007)
- Department of Health (2007) Safer Management of Controlled Drugs: A guide to good practice in secondary care
- Northern Devon Healthcare NHS Trust Medicines Management Policy (2007)
- National Prescribing Centre (2006)
- The College of Operating Department Practitioners' Standard of Good Practice in relation to controlled drugs (2007)

9 Associated Documentation

- NDDH Medicines Policy